
BLUE WHALE EXPEDITION

East Timor: Swim with the Mighty Blue Whale

Seven days on East Timor's remote coastline with underwater photographer and marine biologist Caine Delacy. A group of only seven guests spends five days on the ocean looking for blue whales, with photography coaching, local crew support and a wild-water pace shaped by the animals.

DATES

02 Nov - 08 Nov 2026
09 Nov - 15 Nov 2026

DURATION

7 Days / 6 Nights

LOCATION

Dili, East Timor

GROUP SIZE

7 guests

PRICE

US\$4,850
US\$1,600 deposit

HIGHLIGHTS

A rare blue whale week in one of the least-dived corners of the region

01

5 Ocean Days

Five days on the boat looking for blue whales and other marine life along East Timor's remote coastline.

02

Blue Whales Up Close

When conditions and whale behaviour allow, Caine leads guests into the water with the largest animals that have ever lived.

03

Caine Delacy

Learn from an underwater photographer and marine biologist with a PhD, international publishing credits and deep ocean field experience.

04

Small Group

Just seven guests, with an Airguides trip leader, storyteller guide and experienced local captain and crew supporting the week.

05

Resort Base

Six nights at Aquatica Dive Resort in Timor, with breakfast, boat lunches and relaxed evenings at the resort or in town.

06

Image Craft

Interactive photography masterclasses, optional video and photo coaching, final image review and professional photos from the trip.

THE STORY

One of the last places blue whales still feel truly wild

The waters off East Timor are one of the last places on earth where blue whales move through ocean that feels genuinely untouched.

They come here to feed, following deep currents along a coastline most travellers never reach. The group moves by boat, scanning for the long, low exhale that gives them away, then slipping into the water when Caine, the captain and the crew judge the moment to be right.

This is not a scripted swim. It is a wild ocean experience where timing, weather, visibility, animal behaviour and local knowledge shape each day. That is the point. The encounters matter because nothing is staged.

Beyond the water, the days settle into simple expedition rhythm: small group meals, late afternoons unwinding, conversation with people who have just shared something hard to explain to anyone who was not there.



Blue whale encounters are wild and conditional. Safety, weather, visibility, local rules and whale behaviour decide what is possible each day.

"I aim to give you much more than just seeing these animals and calling it a day. My guides and I know the difference between seeing these animals and truly experiencing wild."

Caine Delacy | Storyteller Guide



YOUR STORYTELLER GUIDE

Caine Delacy

Caine Delacy is an underwater photographer and marine biologist with a PhD, whose career has been built around documenting the state of the world's oceans.

His imagery has been featured in publications across Australia, the UK, South Africa and the US, including standout assignments for The New York Times.

As a guide, Caine brings more than camera advice. He understands animal behaviour, marine ecology and the responsibility that comes with entering the water around wildlife. His coaching works for guests picking up a camera for the first time and for photographers refining a craft they have been building for years.

"The ocean's been my passion since day one. Photography lets me dive deeper, sharing the untold stories of its inhabitants and the world they thrive in." – Caine Delacy



WHY BOOK THIS EXPERIENCE?

Because scale like this changes the way you see the ocean

Blue whales are the largest animals that have ever lived. Nothing prepares you for the scale of them up close.

This expedition is built for travellers who want more than a sighting. Caine and the local team help guests understand what they are seeing: the currents, feeding behaviour, approach decisions, distance, patience and quiet discipline that make wild encounters possible.

East Timor adds another layer. The coastline is raw, the culture is warm and the waters are some of the least-dived in the region. You come for the blue whales, but the place itself stays with you too.



DAY BY DAY

Your East Timor blue whale itinerary

DAY		ARRIVAL
1	Welcome to East Timor Arrive in Dili. Transport will be ready to pick you up from the airport and take you to the resort. Meet Caine Delacy and your fellow guests over dinner, where Caine talks through what to expect in the week ahead.	
DAYS		OCEAN
2-6	Swimming with Blue Whales Breakfast at the resort, then out to the boat for a full day at sea with a packed lunch on board. An experienced local captain and crew help locate blue whales along the coastline. When whales are found, Caine leads the in-water approach if conditions are right. Dinners are at the resort or in town, with free time late each afternoon.	
DAY		FAREWELL
7	Goodbye East Timor After breakfast, join a final session with Caine to review images from the week and talk through what you captured. Farewells follow, then transport from the resort to Dili airport.	



ON THE WATER

Five full days searching the coastline

The core of the trip is boat time. The team heads out each day with a clear purpose: read the water, search for whales and respond carefully when an opportunity appears.

The product page notes a high chance of sperm whales too, alongside blue whales and other marine life. Each day remains wild and flexible, with the captain, crew and Caine making decisions around safety and animal behaviour.

Caine works with guests on approach, timing, light and image-making. The photography and videography workshops are optional, but they add context to every ocean day.

5

days on the ocean looking for
blue whales and marine life

7

guests maximum for a small
group expedition

6

nights at Aquatica Dive Resort
in Timor

1

final image review session
with Caine before departure

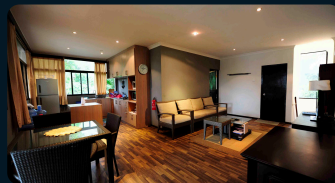
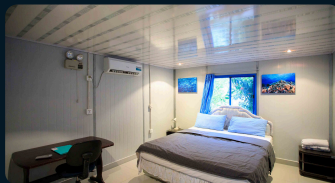
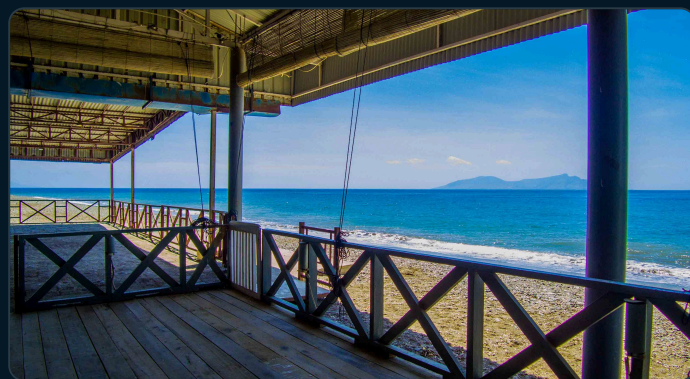
YOUR BASE

Aquatica Dive Resort, Timor

After long ocean days, the group returns to Aquatica Dive Resort, the six-night base listed on the live product page.

The rhythm is practical and relaxed. Breakfast at the resort, lunch packed for the boat and evenings shared at the resort or in town. The resort keeps the expedition close to the water without losing the comfort needed between days at sea.

Shared accommodation is included. A private room is listed as an optional extra and should be confirmed with Airguides before booking.



"Airguides were exceptional hosts for our Raja Ampat liveaboard dive trip. Seamless, professional and incredibly well organised from start to finish."

Adam McKnight | Airguides Raja Ampat guest

THE DETAILS

What's included

Included

- 6 nights / 7 days at Aquatica Dive Resort in Timor, shared basis
- 5 days on the boat looking for blue whales and other marine life
- Storyteller guide Caine Delacy
- Small group of only 7 guests
- All breakfasts and lunches
- Packed lunches out on the boat
- Interactive photography masterclasses
- Optional photography and videography workshops
- Airport transfers
- Professional photos from the trip
- Final image review session with Caine
- Experienced local captain and crew
- Airguides trip leader and expedition support

Wildlife encounters, in-water approaches, boat routing and daily timing depend on weather, safety, sea state, local guidance and animal behaviour.

Not Included

- Camera hire
- Travel insurance, medical costs and evacuation cover
- International flights
- Alcohol
- Passport, visa or entry costs where applicable
- Personal snorkelling, freediving or camera equipment unless specified
- Dinners unless confirmed by Airguides
- Optional private room or single supplement
- Personal expenses and gratuities

FAQ

What guests usually need to know

Who is this trip for?

Anyone who wants to spend time with blue whales and is comfortable in open water. You need to be able to swim confidently, snorkel comfortably and manage boat days where entries may involve swimming to and from the whales.

Do I need to be a photographer?

No. The trip is open to everyone who is confident in the water. Photography and videography workshops are optional, and the main focus is spending time with the whales respectfully.

Are we guaranteed to see whales?

No. This is nature, and it is wild. The product page notes that whales are there every year, but it also says there are no guarantees for how interactions will be. The team works to create the best opportunities while keeping the animals and guests safe.

What should I bring?

Bring a rash vest or thermal top, mask, snorkel, fins, rain jacket or waterproof shell and your camera if you plan to shoot. The product page notes water around 28 to 30 degrees Celsius, but ocean comfort still depends on each guest.

Who leads the trip?

Every Airguides expedition has an Airguides trip leader for logistics and a storyteller guide for the field experience. On this trip, Caine Delacy brings the photography, marine biology and wildlife behaviour expertise.

What marine life might we see?

The trip is built around blue whales. The live product page also notes other marine life and a high chance of seeing sperm whales too, but all wildlife sightings remain conditional.

How should I think about the deposit?

The live product page lists US\$4,850 for pay in full and US\$1,600 for pay deposit. Confirm payment schedule, availability and room configuration directly with Airguides before booking.

PRICING & DATES

Two confirmed November 2026 departures

TRIP PRICE

US\$4,850

Per person, based on the current live product page pay-in-full price.

DEPOSIT LISTED

US\$1,600

The live product page lists this deposit option. Confirm final payment timing and booking terms with Airguides.

02 Nov - 08 Nov 2026 (Confirmed)

09 Nov - 15 Nov 2026 (Confirmed)

7 Days / 6 Nights

7 guests

Availability, currency, room configuration, supplements and payment terms should be confirmed directly with Airguides before booking.

READY?

Reserve your place in East Timor with Caine Delacy

Speak with Airguides to confirm current availability, departure choice, payment options, rooming and international flight planning.

Reserve Your Spot

EMAIL

hello@airguides.com

PHONE / WHATSAPP

[\(+61\) 402 552 918](tel:+61402552918)

WEBSITE

airguides.com